HELLOLILLY · DEEP-DIVE

LinkedIn and networking tools

Separate tools, offered where they fit: a findable profile for many, a light plan for some, the right contacts for anyone.

DEEP-DIVE COMPANION TO VERSION 4

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A companion to the HelloLilly Jobseeker Product Vision, Version 4. Principles and boundaries are in Addendum A.

Opening

For some jobseekers, LinkedIn is where the next job will come from. For others it is irrelevant. A plumber in a rural municipality finds work through local firms, word of mouth and the builders' merchant, not through posts. A sixty-year-old care assistant may need nothing more than a tidy profile a recruiter can find. A project manager in Stockholm moving into health tech may need all of it.

So HelloLilly does not offer one LinkedIn package, and it does not ask anyone to market themselves. It offers **separate tools that connect**, and recommends only the ones that fit:

- **LinkedIn Profile** for the many who simply need to be findable.
- **LinkedIn Plan** for the fewer who want to be visible and remembered in their field.
- **Contact Planner** for anyone who needs to reach the right people, on LinkedIn or off it.

For those who use them, the hard parts are prepared, so the person only has to read, adjust, copy, paste and press send.

The approach borrows from what has been measured to work on LinkedIn for a professional platform the author runs: people's own original posts beat shared content, naming and tagging real people widens reach, comments cost nothing and are where most relationships start, and depth beats volume. Here it is translated from a company growth strategy into small, optional steps for one person looking for work.

The division of labour is the same as everywhere in HelloLilly. **The system carries the load**: it builds the profile from the CV, proposes the tasks, finds the people, surfaces their posts, drafts the comments and messages, and keeps track. **The person makes the choices**: whether to use any of it, what to say, whom to contact, and whether to send at all. **The coach does the human work**: encouragement, a second look at the scary message, and an introduction where they can make one.

SECTION 01

The Problem

01

- **How it is:** In many fields, jobs are filled through a recommendation, an introduction or a conversation that started on LinkedIn. Long-term jobseekers often have the thinnest networks, an outdated profile, and the greatest fear of reaching out. Asking also carries a very high threshold of shame: writing to a former manager or team mate can feel like admitting failure, so many people pull away from exactly the contacts most likely to help. At the same time, generic advice tells everyone to "be visible online", including people for whom it makes no sense.
- **What is missing:** Help that matches the person: a findable profile for those who need one, a light plan for those who want more, a way to reach the right people for anyone, and a clear "you do not need this" for those who do not.
- **The effect:** Some people compete only through open adverts when a few contacts would change everything. Others are pushed into online visibility that wastes their energy and adds to their anxiety.
- **Scenario:** A team leader at the company you want to work for posted last week about a problem you solved for years in your old job. You could have commented. You did not, because you did not know what to write, and you were afraid it would look strange. Three weeks later the company hires someone the team leader "got talking to on LinkedIn".

SECTION 02

Who Needs What

02

The tools are recommended from the person's target occupation, region, plan and own wishes, and the coach can adjust the recommendation. Nothing is required.

SITUATION	WHAT HELLOLILLY RECOMMENDS	WHAT IT DOES NOT PUSH
Trades and local work in a small town (plumber, electrician, care assistant, driver)	Contact Planner aimed at local employers and staffing agencies, by phone, email or a visit; Companies by Area; perhaps a basic profile	Posting, LinkedIn plans
Most jobseekers	LinkedIn Profile, so recruiters can find them; Contact Planner for a few targets	Daily posting
Office, professional and specialist roles	LinkedIn Profile, Contact Planner, and the LinkedIn Plan at a gentle pace	Volume
Career changers	LinkedIn Profile telling the story of the change; Contact Planner for informational talks in the new field; the LinkedIn Plan's learning notes	Pretending to be an expert already
People who find all of this too much	Nothing online at first. The coach and the Coach Vault can open doors instead	Anything that adds pressure

The person can switch any tool on or off at any time. "Not for me" is a valid answer, and the system remembers it.

Three tools, connected but separate

TOOL	WHAT IT DOES	WHO IT IS FOR	NEEDS FIRST
LinkedIn Profile	Creates the LinkedIn profile from the CV, field by field	Many	The CV Builder
LinkedIn Plan	Small daily and weekly tasks: comments on relevant posts, new connections, an occasional post	Fewer, by choice	A LinkedIn profile
Contact Planner	Finds the right people at target companies, keeps track of every contact and prepares every step	Anyone who needs to reach people, on or off LinkedIn	Nothing

When a person uses more than one, they connect: the profile is what new contacts see, the plan's comments warm up the people in the Contact Planner, and a reply moves a contact forward. When the LinkedIn Plan is on, the person sees one short list of today's tasks:

TODAY	EXAMPLE
Comment on 2 posts	Maria (team leader, Nordic Cold) posted about shift handovers; a draft comment is ready
Add 5 new contacts	Five people in cold-chain logistics in the Jönköping area, each with a short note
Follow up 1 contact	Erik accepted last week; a "one simple question" message is ready
This week's post (optional)	An idea from your own experience, and whom to mention

SECTION 03

LinkedIn Profile

03

Why: a complete profile is the foundation for everything else, and it is the step most people can finish in one sitting with help.

LinkedIn Profile creates the LinkedIn profile **from the CV**. The same confirmed facts are rewritten the way LinkedIn is read, never with anything that is not in the person's fact bank. The person copies each part into LinkedIn, guided field by field, with a plain-language explanation of where each part goes.

PART OF THE PROFILE	WHAT THE TOOL PREPARES	THE RULE OF THUMB
Photo	A clear photo from Image Studio, "same face, better photograph"	Face visible, plain background, looks like you on a good day
Background image	A simple, calm image related to the person's field	Better plain than busy
Headline	What you do or want to do, and for whom, with the words recruiters search for	"Warehouse team leader · cold chain and logistics · looking for my next role in the Jönköping area" beats "Unemployed"
About	Four or five short sentences in the first person: what you do, what you are good at, one proof, what you are looking for	Your voice, plain Swedish or English, no buzzwords
Experience	Each role with two or three results-focused lines from the CV	The same facts as the CV, never more
Skills	Skills from confirmed tasks, matched to the words in adverts for the target role	Ten good skills beat fifty random ones
Education and certificates	Including courses completed through the Learn and Re-skill route	Recent learning signals momentum
Open to work	Advice on the choice: visible only to recruiters, or the public banner	The person decides; both are fine
Featured	Optional: a post, a certificate, a project	Only if there is something worth showing
Recommendations	A prepared request to two or three people who have seen the person work	One real recommendation beats many skills
Language	Swedish, English or both, depending on the target market	Both from the same facts

The result is checked by the LinkedIn Helper before the person copies it in: *ready*, *ready with one change*, or *not yet*. When the CV changes, for example after a new course, the tool suggests the matching profile update.

SECTION 04

LinkedIn Plan (optional)

04

Why: a small, steady presence makes the person remembered, and the people they later contact will recognise their name.

The LinkedIn Plan is for the people who want to be visible and remembered in their field, and only for them. It is a media plan for one person: a calendar of small tasks, sized to the person's energy.

The task rhythm

CADENCE	TASKS	TIME
Daily (weekdays)	Comment on one or two posts the plan suggests	10 minutes
Every other day	Add three to five new relevant contacts, each with a short note	10 minutes
Weekly	Follow up contacts who accepted; reconnect with one former colleague; review replies	15 minutes
Every one or two weeks	One original post, if and when it feels right	20 minutes
Monthly	Profile check-up; ask for one recommendation; look at what worked	20 minutes

About an hour a week in total. The plan adapts: the person chooses an intensity (**gentle**, **steady** or **active**), and on a hard day the plan offers one small task, or none, and that counts. Every task is placed in My Week at a time the person picks, and appears in Progress Support as a small step, never as a streak to keep.

What works, in plain words

- **Your own words beat shared content.** A short original post beats resharing an article or a company post.
- **Comments cost nothing and build the most.** A thoughtful comment is seen by the other person's network, and it is where most new relationships begin. For a beginner, comments are the main activity.
- **Naming real people widens reach.** A post that mentions and tags a real person is shown to their network too. Measured on a professional page the author runs, posts tagging a named person reached noticeably more people.
- **One a day, at most.** A second post on the same day takes reach from the first. For a jobseeker, one post every week or two is plenty.
- **Depth beats volume.** One honest post with something only you know is worth more than five generic ones.
- **Stay for the first hour.** Post when you can answer the first comments.

The two-part test for every post

> **1. Does it contain something only you could know? A lesson from your trade, something you noticed on a course, a real situation you handled.**
> **2. Does it end with a real question? Something specific people in your field could answer.**

A post that passes both is an invitation. A post that only tells is a broadcast.

Post ideas the plan suggests

The plan proposes ideas from the person's own fact bank and recent activity, never invented experiences:

TYPE	EXAMPLE IDEA	WHY IT WORKS
The lesson from experience	"Twenty years in cold-chain logistics taught me one thing about temperature logs that no system catches…"	Shows expertise without bragging
The observation	"Three care homes I visited this month all had the same problem at shift change…"	Shows you think about the work
The learning note	"Week three of my electrician course. The thing that surprised me most…"	Momentum and direction
The thank-you	"I want to thank @Anna, who explained load planning better in ten minutes than any manual…"	Generous, tags a real person, travels
The building-on post	"As @Johan put so well in his post about warehouse safety, … I would add one thing from my years on the floor…"	Joins a conversation that already has an audience
The real question	"For those in health tech: what do you wish people coming from nursing understood on day one?"	Invites help without asking for a job
The clear ask (rarely)	"I am looking for my next role as a team leader in logistics around Jönköping. If you know someone I should talk to, I would be grateful."	Makes it easy to help

House rules

- No "Agree?", no "Thoughts?", no bait for comments.
- Hashtags sparingly, or not at all.
- One idea per post; no two posts on the same day.
- Nothing untrue, nothing negative about a former employer.
- Your words. The system suggests ideas, shapes, shortens and checks; it never posts and never invents an experience.

SECTION 05

Contact Planner

05

Why: the people who matter most in a job search are often strangers, and growing a relevant network steadily is what makes every later post, search and request reach further.

The Contact Planner is not limited to LinkedIn. For a plumber or a care assistant, the right step may be a phone call, an email or a visit, and the planner prepares those in the same way.

Choose the targets

The person chooses what they are aiming at, in any combination:

- **Companies** they would like to work at (from the Company List, Companies by Area or Job Radar);
- **Industries** they want to work in;
- **Roles** they want to have;
- **A region**, if location matters.

Find relevant new people

For each target, the Contact Planner searches public profile and post information and suggests people, grouped by role, with a short reason why each one is relevant:

WHO	WHY THEY MATTER	WHAT THEY USUALLY RESPOND TO
Senior leaders	They set direction and can open any door	Brief, relevant, respectful; best reached through a comment first
Hiring managers	They decide	Evidence you understand their team's problem
HR and talent	They run the process	Clarity on role, location and availability
Recruiters	They fill roles every week	A clear profile and a clear ask
Future team members	They know the real job, and they refer	Genuine curiosity about their work
Industry people	They know who is hiring before the advert	A real question about the field
People like you	Others who made the same move or work in the same trade	Shared experience

It also suggests **warm contacts**: family and friends, former colleagues, people from a course or placement, members of the HelloLilly community in the same field, and people from the person's own Network Map.

Add them, gently

Each suggestion comes with a short, personal connection note, drafted from the person's facts and, where possible, from something the other person recently posted:

> **"Hi Maria, I enjoyed your post about shift handovers. I have led night shifts in cold-chain logistics for many years and would be glad to follow what you share."**

The person reads it, adjusts it, copies it into LinkedIn and sends.

Every contact, every step

Every contact is kept in one simple list, with its stage and its next step:

STAGE	MEANING	NEXT STEP IT PREPARES
Suggested	Found as relevant	Follow, or comment first
Warmed	The person has commented on their post	A connection request with a note
Connected	They accepted	A thank-you, or "one simple question"
In conversation	They replied	Ten minutes of advice, or a follow-up
Helping	They offered advice, an introduction or a referral	A thank-you, and an update later
Resting	No reply after one follow-up	Nothing; respect the silence

Contacts can be linked to companies, jobs and applications at any time, so the person sees who they know at the company where they just applied.

The approach menu

From the gentlest to the boldest. The person picks what feels possible today.

APPROACH	WHAT IT IS	COURAGE NEEDED
Comment on their post	A thoughtful comment, no ask at all	Lowest
Connect with a short note	A personal two-line note	Low
One simple question	"I would love to work in your industry. Would you mind if I asked you one simple question?"	Medium
Ask for ten minutes of advice	A short conversation about their field, not about a job	Medium to high
Ask for an introduction or a recommendation	Only once there is a relationship	Highest

The order matters. A recommendation request to a stranger rarely works; the same request after a comment, a connection and a short conversation often does.

SECTION 06

Comments, the Gentlest First Step

06

Why: commenting is the single most valuable and least risky thing a beginner can do on LinkedIn, but finding the right posts and knowing what to write is exactly where people stop.

Each day, for those who use the LinkedIn Plan or the Contact Planner, the system shows a few recent posts worth answering, from:

- new contacts the person has just added or wants to warm up;
- people at target companies;
- people in the target field;
- existing connections who posted something relevant.

For each post it shows why it is worth a comment, and a draft in one of five shapes, written from the person's own experience:

1. **Add from experience:** "In my years running night shifts, we saw the same thing. What worked for us was..."
2. **A precise question:** one specific, answerable question about the post.
3. **A respectful other view:** "I read this a little differently, for one reason..."
4. **An extension:** "This also holds for small warehouses, with one twist..."
5. **A thank-you with substance:** what in the post was useful, and why.

The person picks one or two, adjusts, copies, comments. When a comment leads to a reply, the Contact Planner moves that contact to the next stage and prepares the next step.

SECTION 07

Designed for Introverts and Beginners

07

The biggest wall is often not skill but shame. Asking a former manager or team mate for help can feel like admitting failure, and research with long-term unemployed people finds that this shame makes them withdraw from the very networks that could help. So the tools lower the threshold on purpose:

- **Reconnect before you ask.** The first message to an old contact asks for nothing: congratulations on a new role, a comment on a post, a thank-you for something they taught.
- **Advice, not a job.** The ask that follows is for ten minutes of advice about their field. People like being asked for advice; few like being asked for a job.
- **Your status is yours to share.** No message has to mention being out of work unless the person chooses to. Many people say "I am looking at my next step", which is true.
- **Someone else can carry the ask.** When asking is still too hard, the door can open through a coach's network instead, through Network Match, so the person does not have to ask at all.

Around that:

- **No calls required.** Everything can happen in writing, at the person's own pace.
- **Scripts, not improvisation.** Every comment and message is prepared; the person only has to approve it.
- **Small numbers.** Five new contacts is a good day; one comment is a good day too.
- **"Not today" is valid.** The plan offers something smaller, or nothing.
- **Kind framing of silence.** Most messages get no answer for reasons that have nothing to do with the person. The tools say so, and show the replies that did come.
- **A coach on hand.** The scary message can go to a coach for a second look first.
- **The LinkedIn Helper on everything.** Every text can be checked before sending: *send*, *send with one change*, or *hold*. After *send* it offers nothing more.

SECTION 08

Safety, Honesty and Boundaries

08

- **The person always sends.** Nothing is ever posted, sent, liked or connected automatically. Every tool stops at the send button.
- **Public information only.** People and posts are found from public information. Nothing behind a login is ever scraped, and the person's account is never automated.
- **No mass messaging.** Small daily numbers; generic outreach harms the person's reputation.
- **True claims only.** The profile, posts and messages use the person's confirmed facts and own words.
- **Respect for the other person.** One follow-up at most; silence and "no" are respected.
- **No vanity scores.** No follower targets, no "your messages landed well" score.

The people search and post search behind the Contact Planner and the LinkedIn Plan already run on another platform the author operates, reused here under these rules.

SECTION 09

What Success Looks Like

09

MEASURE	WHY IT MATTERS
Profile complete and checked	The foundation
Profile views from people at target companies	The right people are finding you
New relevant contacts added, and accepted	The network grows in the right direction
Comments that got a reply	Relationships are starting
Conversations and informational talks	Doors are opening
Introductions and recommendations	The strongest route to a job
Interviews that came through people	The outcome

SECTION 10

How the Tools Connect to the Rest of the Site

10

CONNECTED TOOL	THE CONNECTION
CV Builder and fact bank	The source of every profile line; LinkedIn Profile opens after the CV
Image Studio	The profile photo
My Plan	The target roles, industries and region that drive targets and post ideas
Company List, Companies by Area and Job Radar	The companies the Contact Planner works on
Job Applications	When a job is found or applied for, the hiring manager and team appear as suggested contacts
Coach Vault and Network Match	Where a coach's network reaches a company, a personal introduction is offered as the strongest first step
Learn and Re-skill	Learning notes for posts, new skills on the profile, and informational talks in a new field
Placement Finder	People at placement employers, reached the same gentle way
Interview Preparation	The panel's public profiles for research, and a thank-you after the interview
Community and Shared Bank	Openers, comments and posts that worked for others, offered as options; community members as warm contacts
Tutorial Library	Short clips: a profile in an hour, your first comment, your first post
Coach Review	A second look at the profile or a scary message
Progress Support and Lilly	Today's tasks as small steps, and help finding the next action

SECTION 11

A Thirty-Day Starter Plan

11

WEEK	FOCUS	THE TOOLS PREPARE
Week 1	Get findable	The full profile from the CV; the photo; two recommendation requests
Week 2	Listen and comment	Twenty people and ten companies to follow; one or two comments a day from the plan
Week 3	Connect	The first targets; five new contacts every other day with notes; five former colleagues to reconnect with
Week 4	First post and first ask	One post idea that passes the two-part test, tagging one real person; one "one simple question" message

After thirty days, most people have a complete profile, a growing network in the right field, a handful of real conversations, and the beginnings of a name people recognise in their field, at the size a jobseeker needs.

Appendix: Example Messages

Shown in English here; in the product they are prepared in Swedish or English, from the person's own facts and the other person's real post.

A comment that adds from experience "Thank you for this, Maria. In my eight years leading night shifts at a cold store, the handover was always where things slipped. What helped us was a two-minute standing check at the temperature log. Have you seen anything similar work in larger sites?"

A connection request after a comment "Hi Maria, I commented on your post about shift handovers. I have worked in cold-chain logistics for many years and would be glad to follow what you share."

One simple question "Hi Erik, thank you for connecting. I would love to work in health tech after twelve years as a nurse. Would you mind if I asked you one simple question about how you made the move?"

Ten minutes of advice "Hi Sara, I have really appreciated your posts about warehouse automation. I am exploring roles in the field and would value ten minutes of your perspective on what employers look for right now. If it suits you, any time next week would work for me. If not, no problem at all."

A recommendation request, to someone who knows your work "Hi Johan, I hope you are well. I am looking for my next role as a team leader, and a short recommendation from someone who saw my work would mean a lot. If you are willing, I would be happy to suggest a few points you could mention. Thank you either way."

A thank-you after a conversation "Thank you for your time today, Anna. Your point about certificates was exactly what I needed to hear. I will look into the course you mentioned and let you know how it goes."